Summing up

Officials of the Indian government tend to be averse to changing things. This is rooted in the bureaucratic incentives that penalize failure. In order to make faster progress, we need to create an institutional culture that is more accepting of failure.

Part of the problem lies in the official line, which does not recognize or discuss failure. But most public policy work is characterized by failure, and we would all be better off by discussing this in a comfortable and realistic way.

When a policymaker lays claim to omniscience, it is difficult to admit that a mistake was made. It is better to honestly speak about the uncertainties that are being faced, and embark on policymaking as a process of discovery.